About Me

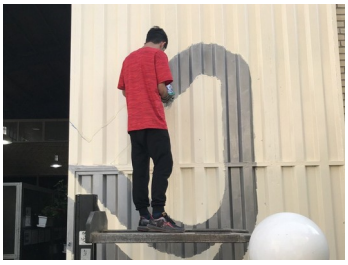
I am Mahyar Jaberi, a Computer Science student at York University and an AI Solutions Engineer co-op at FGF Brands. I build products people use, end to end, and I never give up on them. My SWOT lists this as my main strength (*Personal SWOT Analysis*, n.d.). Outside work, I code my own projects and go to the gym.

I was born in Mashhad and grew up in Vanak, Tehran. Street soccer by the *zurkhaneh* (a traditional gym) across from our house is how I met so many people, and 45-minute walks to Abo Atash Park made me the independent person I am today. My inspiration is my dad. I admire how he kept his factory going through years of economic problems and stayed true to his rules: never get so big and rich that you lose yourself, keep your work clean, and help people. Those are my rules now, and he showed me that if I want to build something, I can. Before I left Iran, I drew the factory's logo on its door (Artifact 1).

When I moved to Canada for grade 11, my English was weak and I ate lunch alone all year, but my first computer science course made me fall in love with coding. I became the best Python coder in my school by grinding until I figured things out. When another university offered me Statistics instead, I chose York's Lassonde School of Engineering to study Computer Science and stay close to my family. That grind got me noticed in my network science course, and now I do research with Professor Papagelis.

Outside class, I spent three years at Pet Valu, where customers kept asking what to feed allergic dogs, so I built BowlWise, an AI tool that answers honestly for each dog. People doubted it, but I kept going and showed it to Pet Valu's C-suite. Even so, speaking confidently in my second language is still my weakness, so my SMART goal at FGF is to give a short update in team meetings every two weeks until March 2027, with monthly feedback. As a visual learner (EducationPlanner.org, n.d.), I plan and explain my work in colour-coded diagrams.

My top 10 values (*Values Assessment*, n.d.) tell the same story, so none surprised me: six are about work, which shows building comes first now. Three meet in BowlWise (Artifact 2): a product I can see means people using what I made, long-term effort is shaping an idea for months when others doubt it, and helping people means answering customers' real questions. Intellectually stimulating work is a hard problem I can grind at, like my network science course. Creative work is making things look good, like the factory logo I drew. Being my own boss means building a company like my dad did, so I co-founded an AI finance app. The form misses honesty and hard work, values my dad lived by: I keep my work clean, like BowlWise's honest answers, and grind until I figure it out. Time for my interests means free hours to draw, but my work values leave little of it now. My sport is the gym: after a year of training wrong alone at York, friends taught me how my body works, and training keeps me sharp for work, though I skip it for my startup. Living near relatives means staying with my parents, which is why I chose York. Travel shows me how others live: in Norway and Sweden, seeing people with secure jobs hike after 4 p.m. broke my heart at first. But every place has pros and cons, and I can always go there to study or work, so I stop comparing, believe in myself, and enjoy the moment.



Artifact 1 (About Me). *Drawing my dad's factory logo, my closest memory of it. I picked it because it holds my roots, my art, and my dad, who inspires me.*



Artifact 2 (Values). *With my Pet Valu team at the 50th anniversary conference, where I showed BowlWise to the CMO and CTO. I picked it because it shows three of my values: a product I can see, long-term effort, and helping people.*

References

EducationPlanner.org. (n.d.). *What's your learning style? 20 questions*. http://www.educationplanner.org/students/self-assessments/learning-styles-quiz.shtml

Personal SWOT analysis [Course module]. (n.d.). LE/COOP 2100 A, York University eClass.

Values assessment [Course handout]. (n.d.). LE/COOP 2100 A, York University eClass.